

LOW PHOSPHORUS DIET GUIDE

GOAL: Limit phosphorus intake to reduce strain on the kidneys and maintain bone and heart health.

FOODS TO EAT	FOODS TO AVOID
1. FRUITS BEST CHOICES: APPLES, BERRIES, GRAPES, PEACHES, PINEAPPLE, WATERMELON, PLUMS, CHERRIES, AND TANGERINES. <i>WHY:</i> Naturally low in phosphorus and rich in antioxidants.	1. HIGH-PHOSPHORUS DAIRY PRODUCTS AVOID: MILK, CHEESE, YOGURT, ICE CREAM, AND CREAM SOUPS. <i>WHY:</i> Contain large amounts of phosphorus and calcium that can build up in the blood.
2. VEGETABLES BEST CHOICES: CABBAGE, CAULIFLOWER, CUCUMBERS, BELL PEPPERS, LETTUCE, CARROTS, GREEN BEANS, ZUCCHINI, AND ONIONS. <i>WHY:</i> Provide vitamins and fiber without adding excess phosphorus. TIP: Boil high-phosphorus vegetables (like potatoes or spinach) to reduce phosphorus content.	2. NUTS, SEEDS & LEGUMES AVOID: ALMONDS, PEANUTS, CASHEWS, SUNFLOWER SEEDS, LENTILS, BLACK BEANS, AND CHICKPEAS (IN LARGE PORTIONS). <i>WHY:</i> High in organic phosphorus, which is difficult for kidneys to process.
3. GRAINS & STARCHES BEST CHOICES: WHITE RICE, REFINED PASTA, COUSCOUS, CREAM OF WHEAT, AND WHITE BREAD. <i>WHY:</i> Whole grains are nutritious but tend to contain more phosphorus. Choose refined versions instead.	3. WHOLE GRAINS & BRAN CEREALS AVOID: BRAN FLAKES, OATMEAL, GRANOLA, WHOLE-GRAIN BREAD, BROWN RICE, AND WHOLE WHEAT PASTA. <i>WHY:</i> Contain higher phosphorus than refined grains.
4. PROTEIN (LOW-PHOSPHORUS) BEST CHOICES: EGG WHITES, CHICKEN OR TURKEY (SKINLESS, SMALL PORTIONS), LEAN BEEF OR FISH (LIMITED AMOUNTS), UNSALTED CANNED TUNA. PLANT-BASED OPTIONS (MODERATE PORTIONS): TOFU, CHICKPEAS, LENTILS (SMALL PORTIONS). <i>WHY:</i> Provides necessary protein while minimizing phosphorus load.	4. PROCESSED & FAST FOODS AVOID: SAUSAGES, HOT DOGS, DELI MEATS, FROZEN DINNERS, INSTANT NOODLES, AND SNACK BARS. <i>WHY:</i> Often contain phosphate additives (used as preservatives and flavor enhancers).
	5. DARK SODAS & DRINKS AVOID: COLA, ROOT BEER, ENERGY DRINKS, AND SOME FLAVORED WATERS. <i>WHY:</i> Contain phosphorus additives in the form of phosphoric acid.